Headspace

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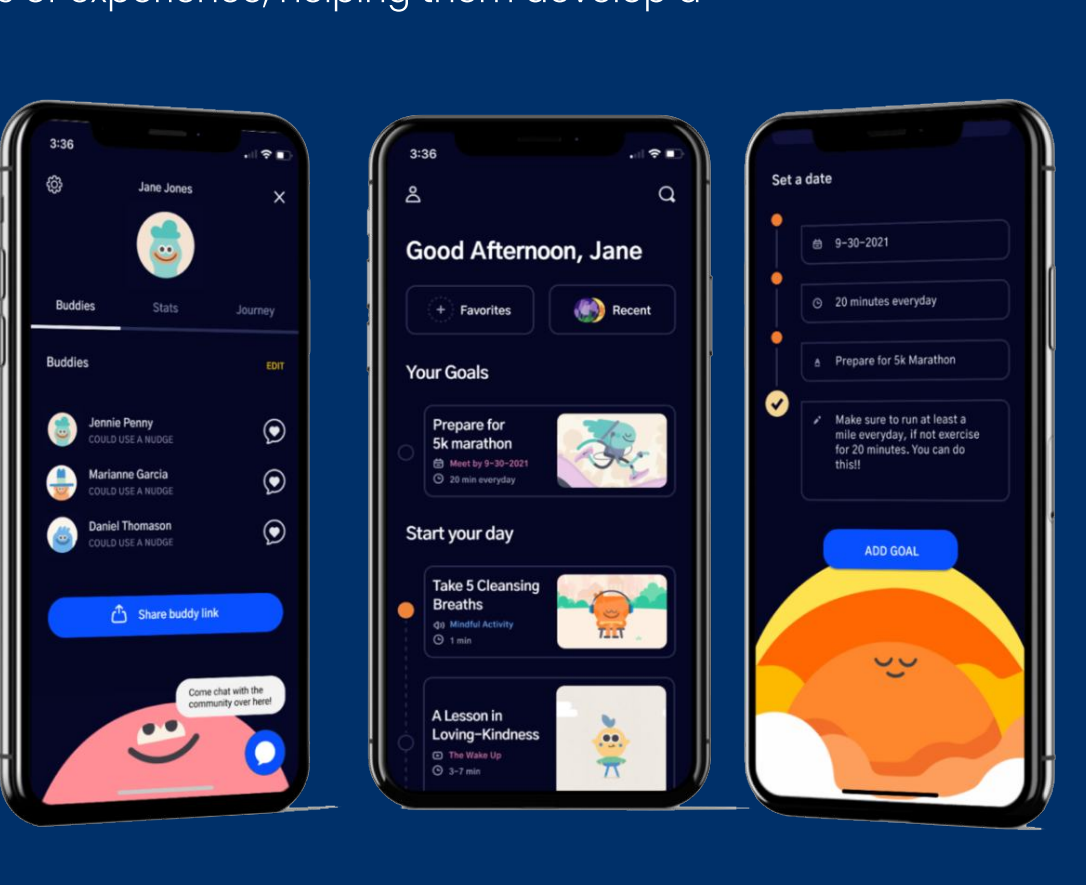
IXD - Visual Design

What is Headspace?

Headspace is a popular app that offers guided meditation and mindfulness practices designed to improve mental well-being and overall health. Founded on the principles of making meditation accessible and easy to integrate into daily life, Headspace provides users with tools to manage stress, reduce anxiety, enhance focus, and improve sleep. Through a combination of short guided sessions, sleep aids, focus music, and educational courses, the app empowers users to build healthier habits and cultivate resilience. Backed by scientific research, Headspace caters to people at all levels of experience, helping them develop a calmer, more mindful approach to life.



Visual Style

colour pattern

🟧 #FF7F1D
🟦 #0C6FF9
⬛ #413D45
🟦 #00A4FF
🟨 #FFCE00
🟩 #01A652
⬜ #FFFFFF

Typography

Aa

Aperçu and Aperçu Mono

abcdefghijklmnopqrst uvwxyz .!@#$%^&*(~)	`Use for headlines, and bold, declarative moments`
abcdefghijklmnopqrst uvwxyz .!@#$%^&*(~)	`Use for sub-headlines, pull-quotes, or other important but not the most important things`

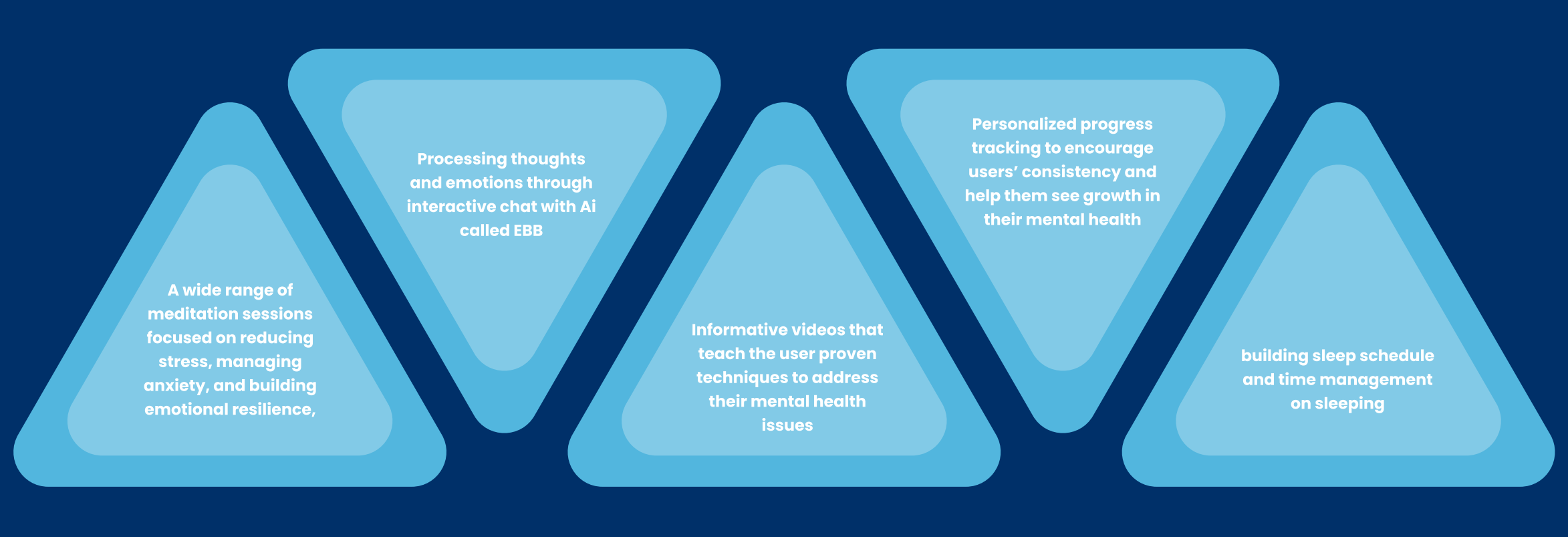
Say hello to Headspace Aperçu

App icons

primary purpose

Mental health support

Key Features



A wide range of meditation sessions focused on reducing stress, managing anxiety, and building emotional resilience,

Processing thoughts and emotions through interactive chat with Ai called EBB

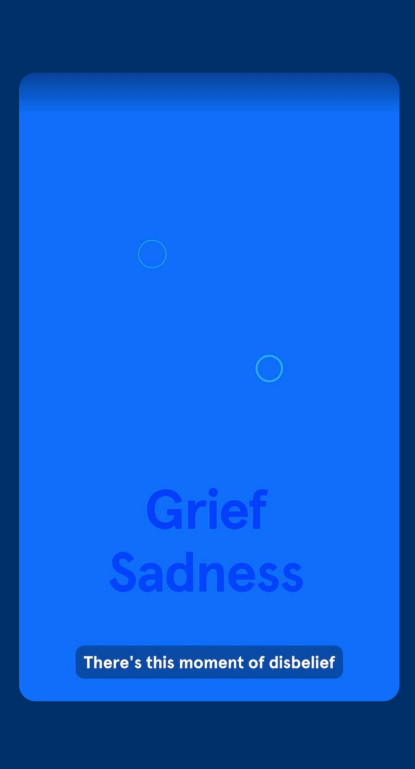
Informative videos that teach the user proven techniques to address their mental health issues

Personalized progress tracking to encourage users' consistency and help them see growth in their mental health

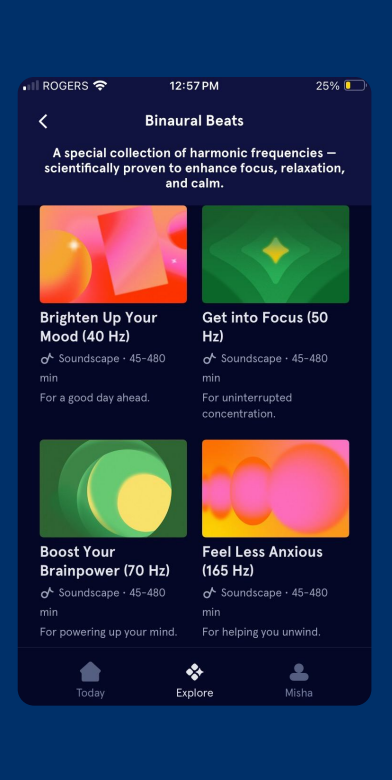
building sleep schedule and time management on sleeping

initial impressions

- positive feedback from completing tasks in a checklist format allows the user to see their progress in a way that they may feel accomplishment or productive.
- Home screen features accessible easy activities that are not too time consuming
- Creates an inviting atmosphere for new users to explore the features and functions of the app.
- The videos include simple graphics and animation that encapsulate the feelings/emotions being addressed/described – an example is the sinking feeling you may have when experiencing the onset of grief, this was depicted by a rising blue ocean with sinking dark blue text that said grief and sadness with popping bubbles.
- Who is the target audience? how are the daily tasks related to the user?
- the visual elements of the videos and the app itself are calming and well selected
- the variable structure of the app drives the user to explore the different methods and techniques available to them
- new users may feel overwhelmed by the vastness of the content
- there is a subscription price which will deter alot of people from trying it even though it is not breaking the bank



Grief
Sadness
There's this moment of disbelief



Binaural Beats

A special collection of harmonic frequencies – scientifically proven to enhance focus, relaxation, and calm.

Brighten Up Your Mood (40 Hz)
Soundscape · 45-480 min
For a good day ahead.

Get into Focus (50 Hz)
Soundscape · 45-480 min
For uninterrupted concentration.

Boost Your Brainpower (70 Hz)
Soundscape · 45-480 min
For powering up your mind.

Feel Less Anxious (165 Hz)
Soundscape · 45-480 min
For helping you unwind.

Assumptions

- People are more likely to rely on traditional, accessible methods of managing stress (e.g., walking, exercise, and journaling) before seeking out newer digital solutions, such as wellness apps.
- Sleep can be both a sign of relaxation and a coping mechanism, but over-reliance on it may be seen as an issue in some cases.

- Simple activities (walking, relaxing) are often preferred over more structured or technological solutions for relaxation.
- People are drawn to personal, low-effort methods of stress management (e.g., taking a walk, journaling).

- Meditation and mindfulness practices are often underutilized due to perceived time constraints or lack of immediate results.
- Guided features, like meditation prompts or breathing exercises, would be helpful to increase engagement.

- While wellness apps are of interest, users are cautious about spending money on apps they perceive as ineffective.
- Personalization and clear guidance are key to making wellness apps appealing.
- Trust and clear communication (e.g., reviews, recommendations) are crucial in motivating users to try a new wellness app.

- Sleep issues are a common barrier to maintaining mental wellness. An app that integrates sleep management or relaxation techniques could be beneficial.
- Educating users on the link between sleep and mental wellness might help encourage consistent use of wellness tools.

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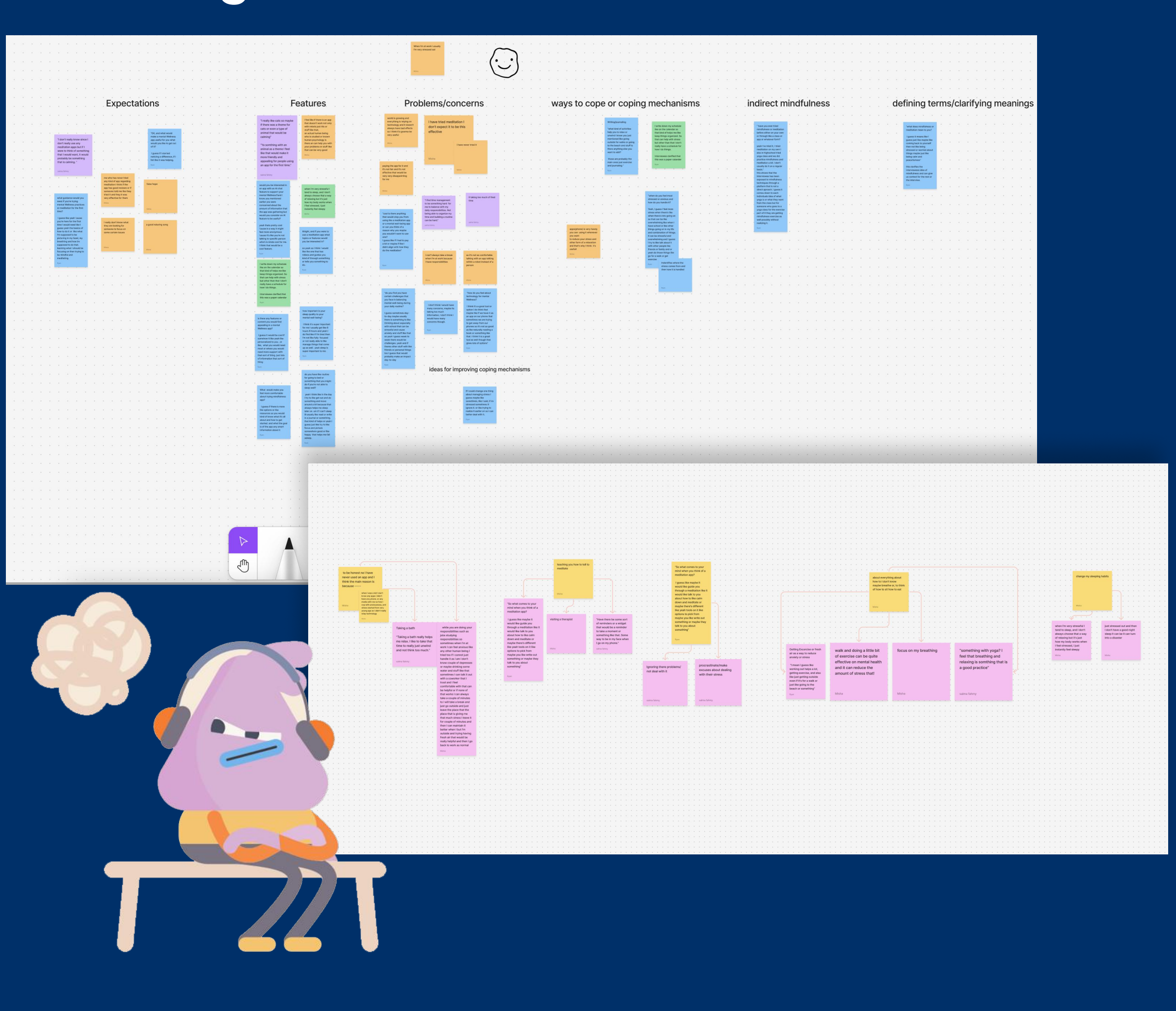
- Mental wellness tools that help users manage or balance responsibilities (like task managers or stress-reduction techniques that fit into busy schedules) could be highly beneficial.
- Simple, accessible reminders or brief exercises could help users cope with stress in real time.

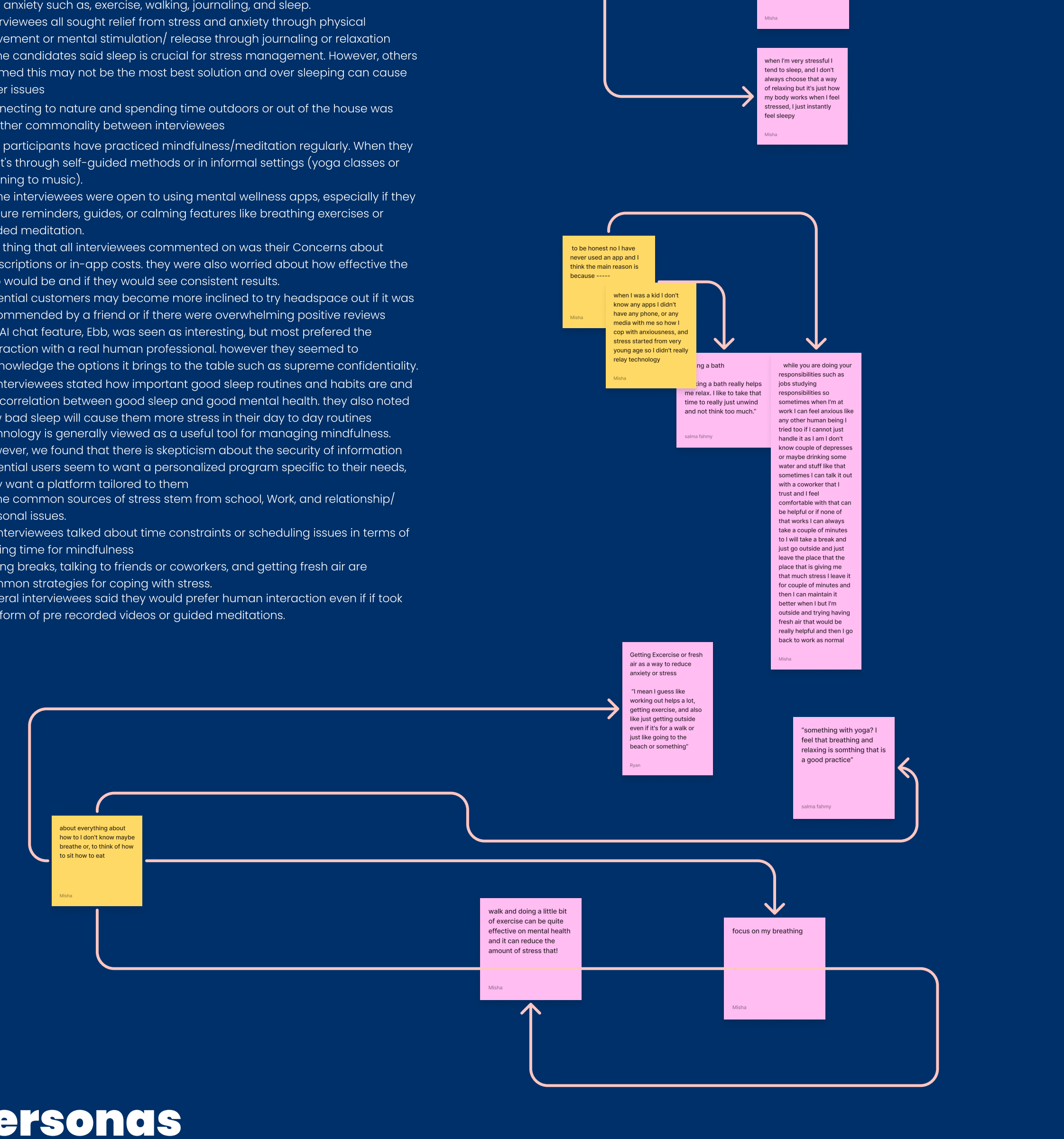
- Wellness apps that integrate personalized feedback or human interaction may resonate more with users who prefer a more customized, emotionally resonant approach.
- A balance between AI-driven content and human support may provide the best user experience for many.

Coding


Expectations
Features
Problems/concerns
ways to cope or coping mechanisms
indirect mindfulness
defining terms/clarifying meanings
ideas for improving coping mechanisms

Insights

- there were a few common ways that each interviewee managed their stress and anxiety such as, exercise, walking, journaling, and sleep.
- Interviewees all sought relief from stress and anxiety through physical movement or mental stimulation/ release through journaling or relaxation
- some candidates said sleep is crucial for stress management. However, others claimed this may not be the most best solution and over sleeping can cause other issues
- connecting to nature and spending time outdoors or out of the house was another commonality between interviewees
- Few participants have practiced mindfulness/meditation regularly. When they do, it's through self-guided methods or in informal settings (yoga classes or listening to music).
- Some interviewees were open to using mental wellness apps, especially if they feature reminders, guides, or calming features like breathing exercises or guided meditation.
- one thing that all interviewees commented on was their Concerns about subscriptions or in-app costs. they were also worried about how effective the app would be and if they would see consistent results.
- potential customers may become more inclined to try headspace out if it was recommended by a friend or if there were overwhelming positive reviews
- the AI chat feature, Ebb, was seen as interesting, but most prefered the interaction with a real human professional. however they seemed to acknowledge the options it brings to the table such as supreme confidentiality.
- All interviewees stated how important good sleep routines and habits are and the correlation between good sleep and good mental health. they also noted how bad sleep will cause them more stress in their day to day routines
- technology is generally viewed as a useful tool for managing mindfulness. However, we found that there is skepticism about the security of information
- potential users seem to want a personalized program specific to their needs, they want a platform tailored to them
- some common sources of stress stem from school, Work, and relationship/ personal issues.
- all interviewees talked about time constraints or scheduling issues in terms of finding time for mindfulness
- Taking breaks, talking to friends or coworkers, and getting fresh air are common strategies for coping with stress.
- Several interviewees said they would prefer human interaction even if if took the form of pre recorded videos or guided meditations.


about everything about how to I don't know maybe breathe or, to think of how to sit how to eat
Misha
Getting Excercise or fresh air as a way to reduce anxiety or stress
"I mean I guess like working out helps a lot, getting exercise, and also like just getting outside even if it's for a walk or just like going to the beach or something"
Ryan
"something with yoga? I feel that breathing and relaxing is somthing that is a good practice"
walk and doing a little bit of exercise can be quite effective on mental health and it can reduce the amount of stress that!
Misha
focus on my breathing
Misha

Personas

John Johnson
Primary user

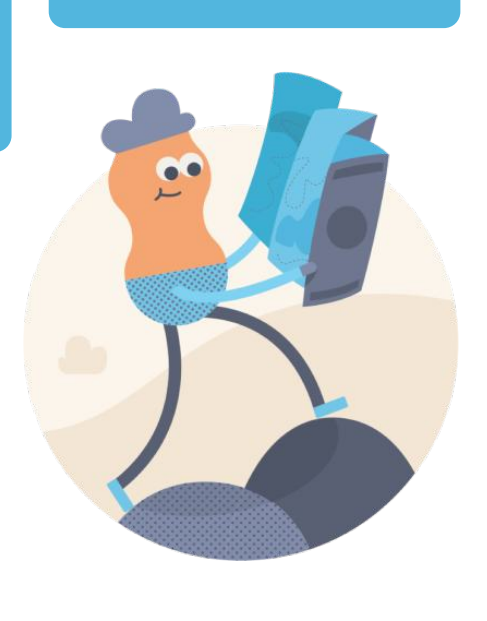
John is 25 years old and works for a restaurant as a front of house manager. He enjoys the outdoors and try's to stay active through sport. john has healthy relationships with his family, friends, and significant other.

Goals
- improve mindfulness to reduce stress and become more productive
- find an outlet for casual self paced mental health support
- become more in tune with his mental health
- learn techniques for reducing stress and anxiety

Barriers
- busy weekly schedule so hard to find time to work on mindfulness
- while john can appreciate how useful technology is for mindfulness, he sometimes feels he needs to disconnect to calm down
- johns current mindfulness coping mechanisms have become habits that are hard to break

Gains
- John is on the right track and with a little help he will see positive results
- john is used to navigating apps and a simple intuitive layout ensures quick learning
- open to trying new ideas, techniques, and methods for improving mindfulness
- Almost always has access to his smartphone

Pains
- john is skeptical about paying for a subscription
- john wants guaranteed results
- john is a very private man and wants his information to be secure
- john is a social person and values face to face interactions
- may feel overwhelmed by the amount of content



Carol Carthage
Secondary user

Carol works in a high-stress environment where her responsibilities often weigh on her. she struggles with balancing work and personal life, and her mental health takes a hit when she's overloaded with tasks. She tries to de-stress by taking breaks during the workday, like going outside for fresh air, but sometimes her workload doesn't allow for consistent self-care. She has tried meditation before but hasn't built it into a regular practice. Her main strategy for managing stress is sleeping it off, but this isn't always effective.

Goals
- find Tools to handle stress that are quick and easy to integrate into a demanding schedule.
- A wellness app that offers flexibility and doesn't require constant engagement.
- A solution to help with sleep issues caused by stress and anxiety.
- Interested in guidance through mental wellness practices like meditation, especially if they focus on work-related stress.

Pains
- Stressed by work demands and feeling under pressure to perform.
- Struggles to prioritize self-care, and neglects mental well-being.
- Hesitant to adopt new tools due to concerns about time, cost, and lack of effectiveness
- Needs more structured and consistent support for managing stress in a way that fits his busy schedule

Barriers
- busy schedule
- base level understanding of technology but will have a bit of a learning curve when introduced to a new app or technology
- quite skeptical about putting her time into an app when theres other proven methods out there
- responds better to face to face interactions

gains
- very in tune with her wants and needs
- although she finds it hard to find time to focus on mindfulness, once Carol is partaking in a mindfulness exercise she gives it her full attention
- values access to proven techniques

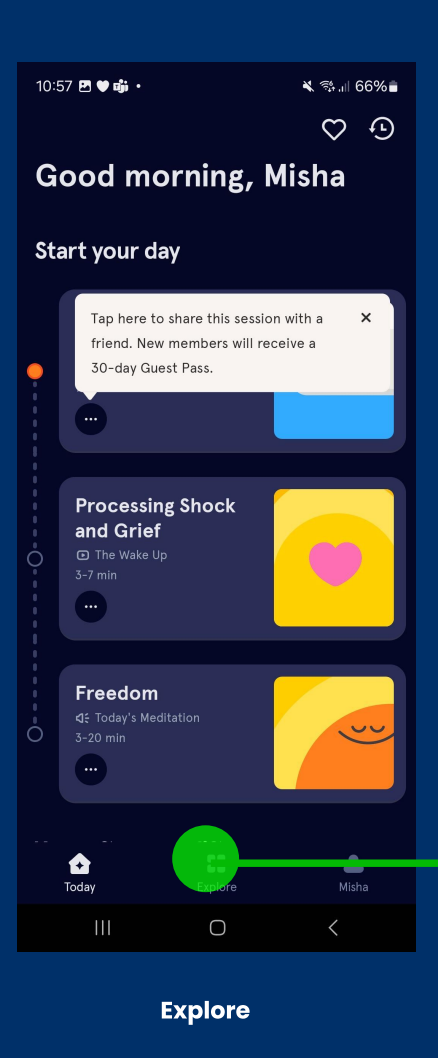
headspace
Stakeholder

Headspace's mission statement is: providing every person life long mental health support. they were founded in 2010 and are accessible worldwide. although the service they provide is a noble one it is a for profit company that is quite successful.

Goals
- Providing mental health support to customers world wide
- improve effectiveness of their service and prove to potential customers that they will see positive results
- increase the amount of users
- continuously improve the user experience of headspace
- increase revenue
- outshine competitors

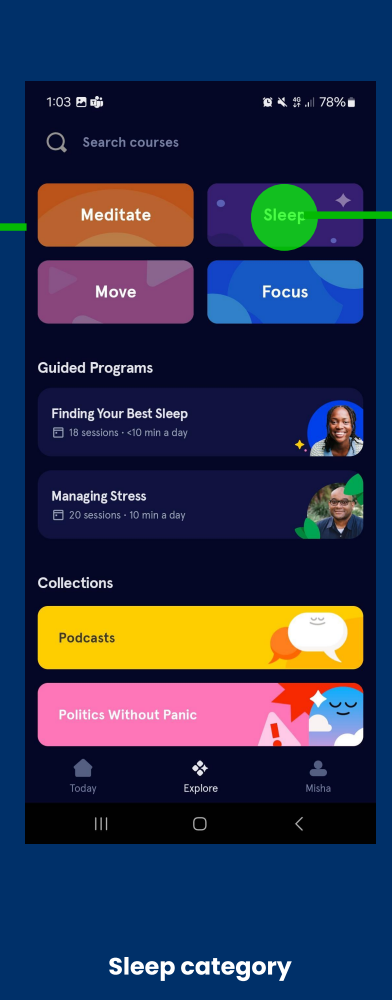
Barriers
- there are other mental health companies that offer similar services to headspace
- reaching their customers through an online or mobile system limits the services and methods they offer
- innovation in the healthcare industry is limited by many factors and new practices are examined thoroughly

interaction points

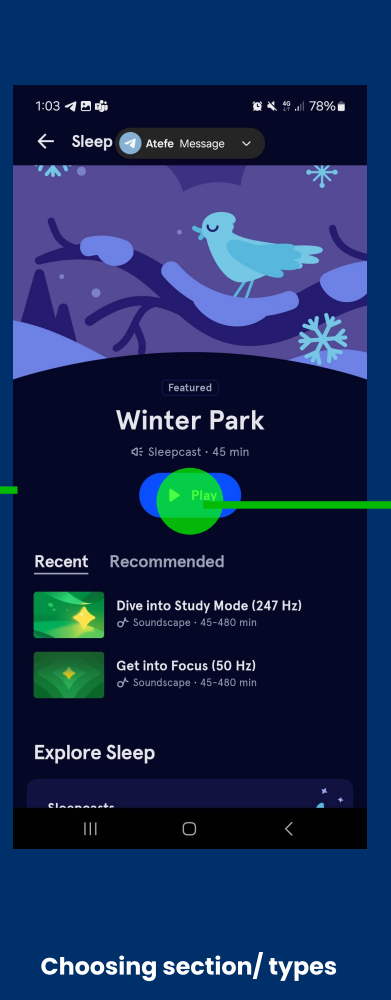


Good morning, Misha
Start your day
Processing Shock and Grief
Freedom

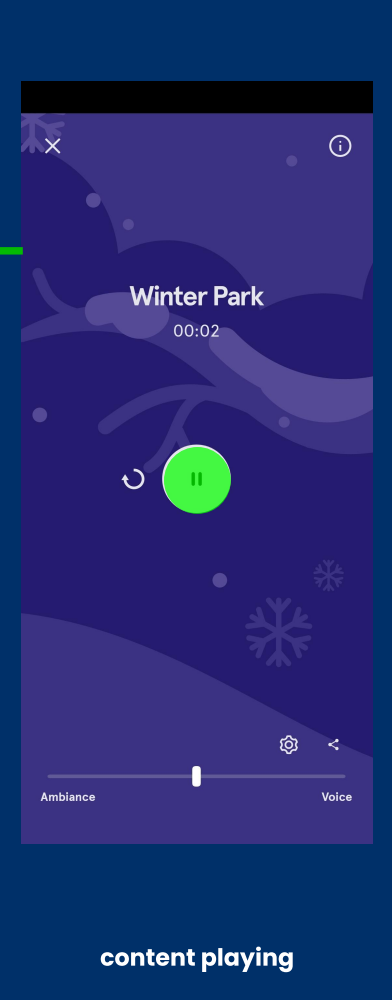
Explore



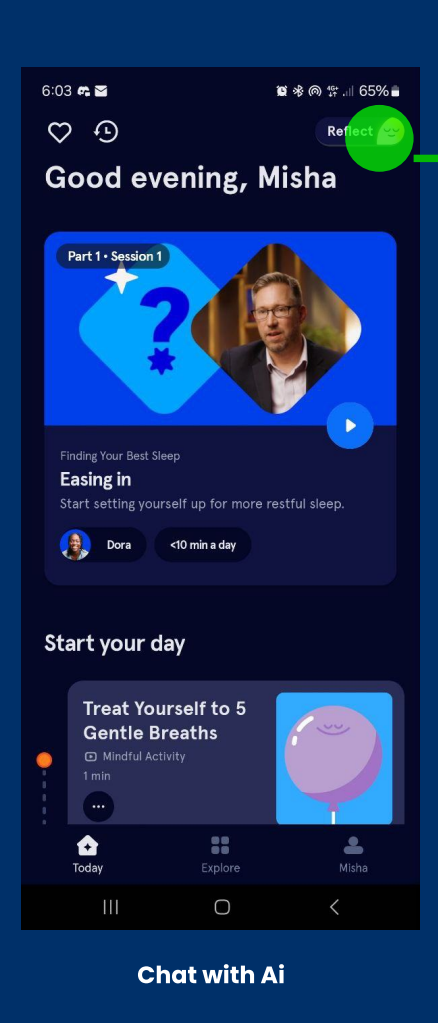
Sleep category



Choosing section/ types

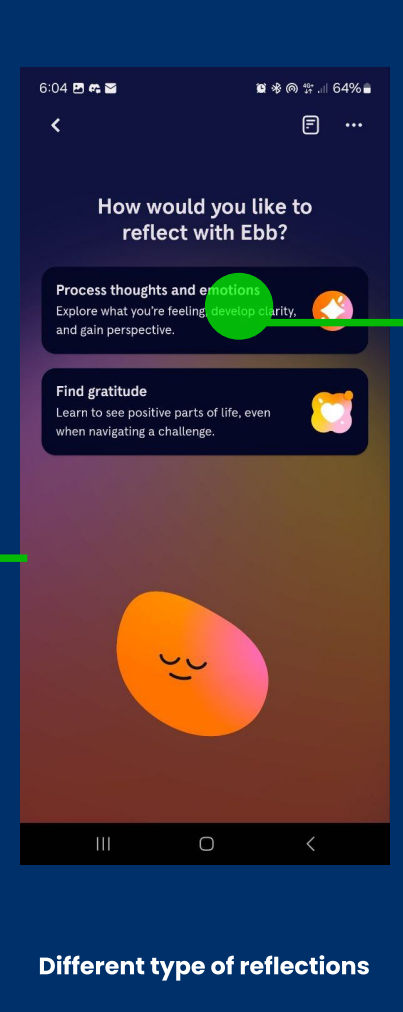


content playing



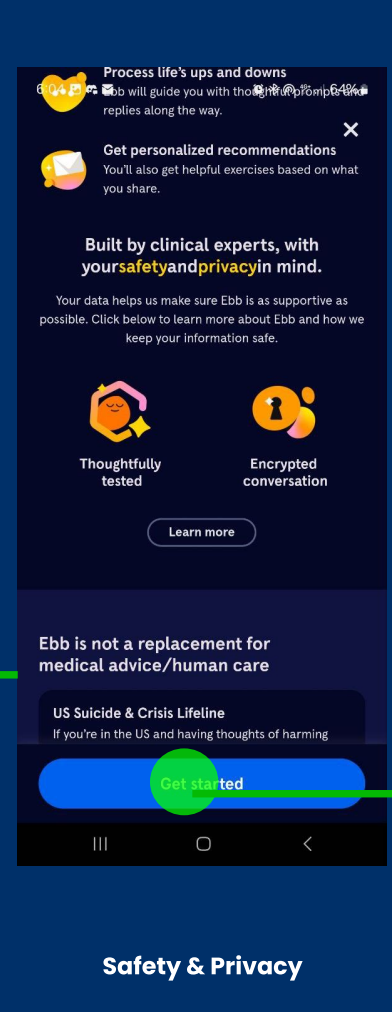
Good evening, Misha
Easing in
Start your day
Treat Yourself to 5 Gentle Breaths
Mindful Activity
1 min

Chat with Ai



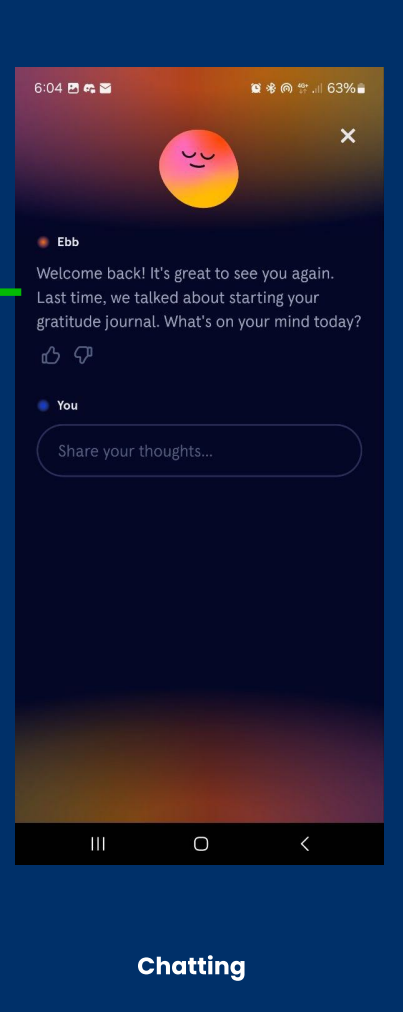
How would you like to reflect with Ebb?
Process thoughts and emotions
Find gratitude

Different type of reflections



Get personalized recommendations
Built by clinical experts, with your safety and privacy in mind.
Thoughtfully tested
Encrypted conversation
Learn more
Ebb is not a replacement for medical advice/human care
US Suicide & Crisis Lifeline
If you're in the US and having thoughts of harming
Get started

Safety & Privacy

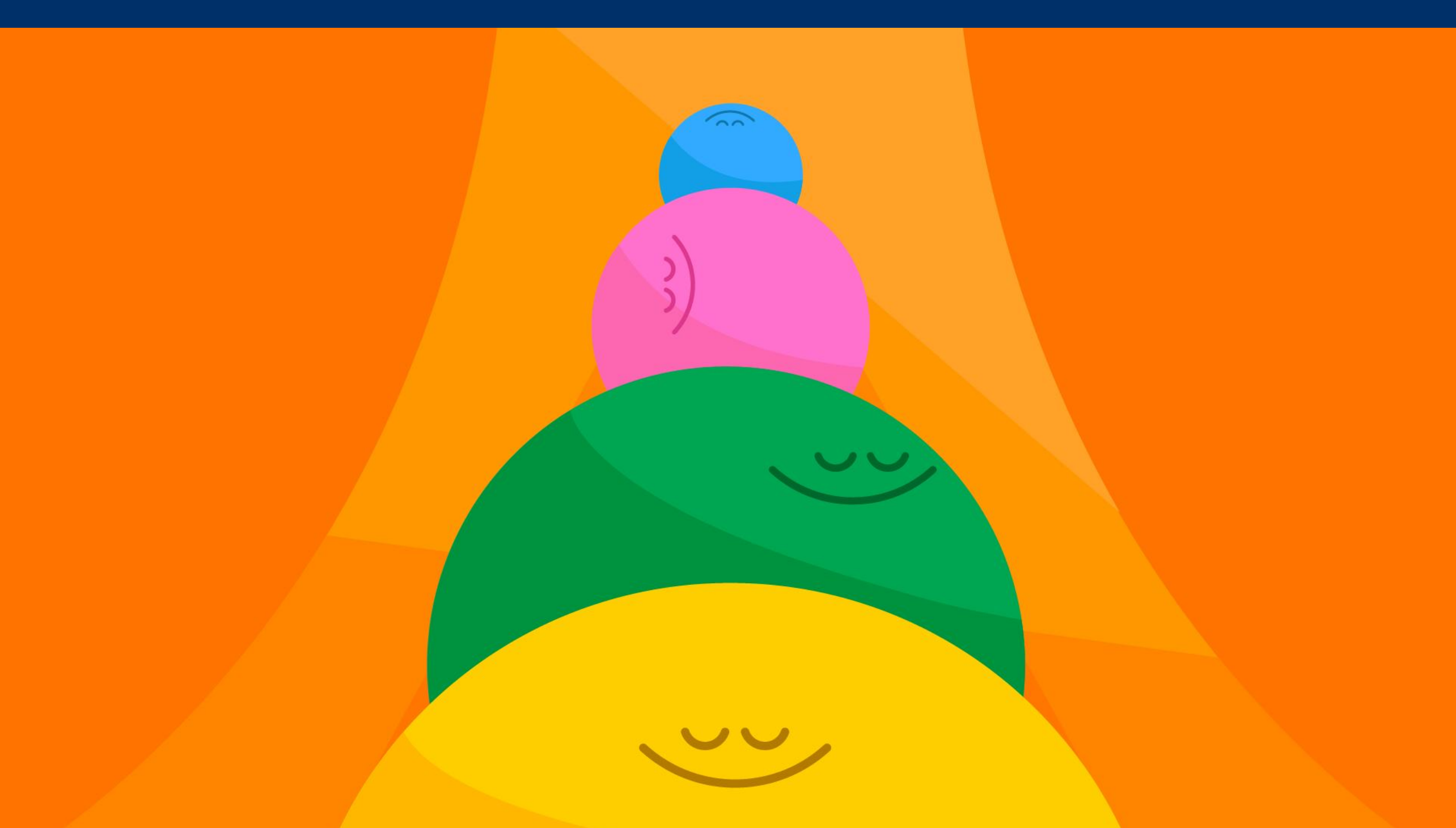


Welcome back! It's great to see you again. Last time, we talked about starting your gratitude journal. What's on your mind today?
Share your thoughts...

Chatting

research methods reflection

- our research method started with an initial individual exploration of the app which we then discussed as a group. we all had some initial comments, assumptions and ideas about the app that we used to help formulate our questions for the interviews. we then did three separate interviews with each team member conducting one interview. after that we analyzed all the transcribed interviews and then coded them based on similarities. we used the similarities to form our insights
- this method was effective but it definitely has its flaws, conducting each interview individually created more work for us on the coding and insights part as we had to go through the other two interviews to find the similarities. if we had all been apart of each interview we would have been able to complete the coding and insights part more efficiently
- for us these were the first interviews we have conducted so there was a lot of learning on the fly happening. looking back there were a few follow up questions that could/should have been asked. i think as we continue to do interviews such as these we will be more present during the interview and able to throw in followup questions on the fly.

Works Cited
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